

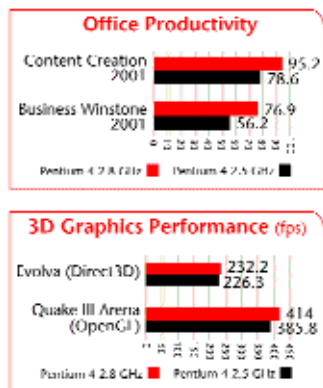
Intel Pentium 4 2.8 GHz processor

Intel's fast new baby

The latest offering from Intel falls just short of the magical 3 GHz mark with a clock speed of 2.8 GHz. Technology-wise, it is no different than its predecessor but with its speed advantage of 300 MHz over the P4 2.53 GHz, top performance is something you can expect out of the box.

We matched this speed demon with equally powerful components, so as to prevent any bottlenecks. The processor sat on the Intel D850EMV2 mainboard and was accompanied by 256 MB of SDRAM, a GeForce 4 Ti4600, a 17-inch Samsung 75E monitor, along with a clean-formatted 20 GB, 7,200-rpm hard disk. The OS used was Windows 2000 with Service Pack 2 and other patches duly applied.

The first part of our test included some games benchmarks—we ran a timedemo on the retail version of *Quake III Arenapatched* with version 1.30. The test was run in three different settings: Normal,



High and Maximum (1024x786x32x32). Here the Pentium 4 2.8 GHz posted a very good score of 434.2 fps in the normal mode. There was barely any difference in the score in the high quality mode—the average frame rate achieved was 414 fps. This means that if you intend to buy the next generation GPU based GeForce 4 card, it would be best complemented by the P4 2.8 GHz processor.

We ran Content Creation

Winstone 2001 as our next test. As this test is mainly processor and memory driven, it helps to measure core-processing power. Here the P4 2.8 GHz posted a record-breaking score of 95.2 in the content creation benchmark, which shows that the processor can easily handle image editing, video editing and multimedia

authoring applications, which tend to be CPU hungry. To further stress the processor, we ran Business Winstone 2001, which is a system-level, application-based benchmark. Here the score of 76.9 posted by the processor truly reflects its power.

Another high-processing

Price: Rs 32,500
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Web site: www.intel.com

power domain is video encoding. We encoded a standard MPEG-2 format video sequence using VirtualDub 1.4. The DivX codec used was version 4.02 and the settings for audio and video processing in VirtualDub were turned to full. The video compression bit rate was set at 900 Kbps. The processor took just 1 minute, 21 seconds to encode a 51 MB video file.

If you already own a 2 GHz processor, there's no need for you to upgrade to 2.8 GHz right away. Besides, to exploit the full potential of this processor, you would definitely require up-to-the-minute supporting hardware.

SPECIFICATIONS

2.8 GHz clock speed/512K on chip cache, Northwood core (0.13 micron)

Pentium 4 2.8 GHz		B+
Performance	» » » » »	
Build quality	» » » » »	
Value for money	» » » » »	
Features	» » » » »	
OVERALL	» » » » »	

LITEON 48x12x48 CD-Writer

Low on price, high on speed

This CD-Writer takes backups of your important data and Audio CDs at the never before offered speed of 48x, which translates to a theoretical transfer rate of 7,200 KBps. With such high speeds at your disposal, the only roadblock is an inappropriate burning medium. It normally takes a long time for the latest media to trickle down to the market—we got hold of 48x media from Princo.

We created an array of files of different sizes ranging from 1 KB to 100 MB and burnt them on to a 650 MB CD. The Writer managed to complete the task in just



2 minutes 54 seconds. It also burnt a 700 MB ISO file in just 3 minutes 10 seconds. We were just as impressed by the audio burn test scores—we burnt a 640 MB Audio CD that contained 14 files and the CD-Writer took 2 minutes 45 seconds to burn this CD. We also conducted a couple of read tests to evaluate its performance as a normal CD-ROM drive. Here we used the previously burnt CD and copied

the files from it on to the hard drive. Here too the LITEON performed well by finishing the task in just 2 minutes.

The Writer features good build quality and the tray and button do not feel tacky. The package includes Nero CD burning software along with two blank media, out of which one is a re-writable CD. The necessary screws and the

Price: Rs 4,795
Contact: Media Tech
Phone: 022-2396696
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Web site: www.liteon.com

audio cable are also provided. All in all, the LITEON 48x CD-Writer is a good choice for those who demand speed. And the attractive price is the icing on the cake.

SPECIFICATIONS

48x (write), 12x (rewrite), 48x (read); ATAPI-E/IDE interface; supports up to Ultra-DMA Mode2 33.3 MBps; 80 ms (typical) access time; 2 MB buffer memory

LITEON 48x12x48		A
Performance	» » » » »	»
Build quality	» » » » »	»
Value for money	» » » » »	»
Features	» » » » »	»
OVERALL	» » » » »	»